

DRAMA

1. Passage anchor

> “In terms of genre, I would describe it as a mix of fiction, fantasy, and philosophical ****drama****.”

Passage meaning

****drama**** = a serious story centered on human conflict, emotion, relationships, or difficult situations

****劇情；戲劇性故事；正劇****

Here, the speaker is describing the book's genre and tone. ****Philosophical drama**** means a serious story that explores ideas about life, choices, regret, meaning, and human experience.

Practice

1. The novel combines fantasy with emotional ****drama****.
這本小說把奇幻元素和情感****劇情****結合起來。
2. I enjoy ****dramas**** that explore difficult moral questions.
我喜歡探討艱難道德問題的****正劇作品****。

Core meanings of DRAMA

2. drama — serious fictional genre

= a story, film, television program, novel, etc. focused mainly on realistic or serious human emotions, relationships, and conflicts

****正劇；劇情類作品****

Examples

1. The film is a family ****drama****.
這部電影是一部家庭****劇情片****。
2. She prefers ****drama**** to comedy.
她比起喜劇更喜歡****正劇****。

This is the closest core sense to the passage.

3. drama — television or film production

= a serious fictional program or film, especially one driven by characters and conflict

****電視劇；劇情片；劇集****

Examples

1. The channel is showing a new historical ****drama****.

這個頻道正在播放一套新的歷史****劇集****。

2. It is a powerful courtroom ****drama****.

這是一部很有感染力的法庭****劇情片****。

Stage play

4. drama — play written for performance

= a play intended to be performed by actors

****戲劇作品；劇本****

Examples

1. The students studied a Shakespearean ****drama****.

學生研讀了一部莎士比亞的****戲劇作品****。

2. The ****drama**** was performed at the local theatre.

那齣****戲劇****在當地劇院上演。

Theatre as an art form

5. drama — dramatic art / theatre

= the art, study, or activity of acting and producing plays

****戲劇；戲劇藝術；戲劇課程****

Examples

1. She studied ****drama**** at university.

她在大學修讀****戲劇****。

2. He teaches ****drama**** at a secondary school.

他在中學教授****戲劇****。

This is distinct from one specific play.

6. drama class / drama school

= class or institution where acting and theatre are studied

****戲劇課；戲劇學校****

Examples

1. She joined the school ****drama class****.

她參加了學校的****戲劇課****。

2. He trained at ****drama school****.

他曾在****戲劇學校****接受訓練。

Real-life excitement / tension

7. drama — exciting or tense events

= a situation involving excitement, tension, uncertainty, or sudden developments

****戲劇性事件；緊張場面；風波****

Examples

1. There was plenty of ****drama**** in the final minutes of the match.

比賽最後幾分鐘充滿****戲劇性場面****。

2. The rescue unfolded with unexpected ****drama****.

救援過程中出現了出乎意料的****緊張情節****。

This sense does not require fiction.

8. dramatic situation / real-life drama

= emotionally intense or eventful real-world situation

****現實中的戲劇性事件；風波****

Examples

1. The election night produced plenty of ****drama****.

選舉之夜出現了不少**戲劇性情況**。

2. Their journey was full of unexpected **drama**.
他們的旅程充滿意外的**波折**。

Interpersonal conflict

9. drama — unnecessary personal conflict

Informal:

= emotional arguments, gossip, tension, or complicated interpersonal problems
人際風波；鬧劇；糾紛

Examples

1. I don't want to get involved in their **drama**.
我不想捲入他們的**人際糾紛**。
2. There is always some **drama** in that group.
那個群體裡總有一些**風波**。

Very common modern informal sense.

10. no drama

= no unnecessary conflict or fuss
不要鬧事；不要製造麻煩

Examples

1. I just want a quiet weekend with **no drama**.
我只想安靜過個週末，**不要有任何風波**。
2. Let's keep this simple—**no drama**.
我們把事情簡單處理，**別鬧得太複雜**。

Exaggerated behavior

11. drama — exaggerated emotional reaction

= overly theatrical or exaggerated behavior in everyday life

****誇張反應；小題大做****

Examples

1. There was no need for all that ****drama****.

根本沒必要那麼****誇張 / 小題大做****。

2. He turned a small disagreement into a huge ****drama****.

他把一場小爭執鬧成了一場大****風波****。

Related forms

12. dramatic

A. relating to drama

****戲劇的****

1. She studied ****dramatic arts****.

她修讀****戲劇藝術****。

B. sudden and striking

****顯著的；巨大的****

2. There was a ****dramatic increase**** in sales.

銷售額出現****大幅增長****。

C. exciting or emotionally intense

****戲劇性的；扣人心弦的****

3. The match had a ****dramatic ending****.

比賽有一個****戲劇性的結局****。

D. exaggerated in behavior

****誇張的****

4. Don't be so ****dramatic****.

別那麼****誇張****。

Very important family polysemy.

13. dramatically

A. greatly / sharply

****大幅地；顯著地****

1. Prices have risen ****dramatically****.
價格已經****大幅上升****。

B. in a theatrical or emotionally striking way

****戲劇性地；誇張地****

2. She paused ****dramatically**** before answering.
她在回答前****戲劇性地****停頓了一下。

14. dramatize / dramatise

A. adapt into dramatic form

****改編成戲劇****

1. The novel was ****dramatized**** for television.
這本小說被****改編成電視劇****。

B. make something seem more exciting or serious than it is

****戲劇化；誇大****

2. He tends to ****dramatize**** small problems.
他常把小問題****戲劇化 / 誇大****。

15. dramatization / dramatisation

= dramatic adaptation or presentation of an event/story

****戲劇化改編；戲劇化呈現****

Examples

1. The series is a **dramatization** of real events.
這套劇是對真實事件的**戲劇化改編**。

2. Some scenes were added for **dramatisation**.
有些場景是為了**戲劇效果**而加入的。

16. dramatist

= person who writes plays
劇作家

Examples

1. He became a successful **dramatist**.
他成為了一位成功的**劇作家**。

2. The **dramatist** is known for political plays.
這位**劇作家**以政治題材戲劇聞名。

Useful compounds

17. historical drama

= dramatic work set in a historical period
歷史劇

Examples

1. The series is a **historical drama**.
這套劇是一部**歷史劇**。

2. She enjoys watching **historical dramas**.
她喜歡看**歷史劇**。

18. crime drama

= dramatic work centered on crime, police, or investigation
犯罪劇

Examples

1. It is a popular **crime drama**.
這是一部受歡迎的**犯罪劇**。
2. He watches several police **dramas**.
他會看幾套警匪**劇集**。

19. family drama

= story focused on relationships and conflict within a family
家庭劇；家庭劇情

Examples

1. The novel is partly a **family drama**.
這本小說部分屬於**家庭劇**。
2. The film develops into an intense **family drama**.
電影逐漸發展成一部情感強烈的**家庭劇**。

20. period drama

= film or television drama set in a particular historical period
時代劇；古裝 / 歷史背景劇

Examples

1. She loves British **period dramas**.
她很喜歡英國**時代劇**。
2. The costumes are a major attraction of the **period drama**.
服裝是這部**時代劇**的一大特色。

High-value expressions

21. create drama

= cause unnecessary conflict, excitement, or trouble
製造風波；惹事

Examples

1. He always seems to **create drama**.
他好像總是在**製造風波**。
2. She was trying not to **create more drama**.
她努力避免**再惹出更多麻煩**。

22. get caught up in the drama

= become involved in emotional conflict or complicated events
捲入風波

Examples

1. I don't want to **get caught up in the drama**.
我不想**捲入那些人際風波**。
2. He became **caught up in the drama** between his friends.
他被**捲進朋友之間的糾紛**。

23. high drama

= extremely tense, exciting, or theatrical situation
高度緊張的戲劇性場面

Examples

1. The final moments were full of **high drama**.
最後幾分鐘充滿**高度緊張的戲劇性場面**。
2. The negotiations ended in **high drama**.
談判在**高度戲劇化的氣氛**中結束。

Key contrasts

24. drama vs play

play

= one specific work written for stage performance

****戲劇作品；劇本****

****drama****

= can mean a play, but also the wider art form or a serious genre

Compare:

> Shakespeare wrote many ****plays****.

> 莎士比亞寫了很多劇本。

> She studies ****drama****.

> 她學習戲劇。

25. drama vs theatre

****drama****

= dramatic literature, acting, or serious fictional storytelling

****戲劇****

****theatre****

= the performing art, activity, or building where plays are performed

****劇場；戲劇藝術****

They overlap, but ****theatre**** often emphasizes performance and staging.

26. drama vs tragedy

****drama****

= broad category of serious conflict-based storytelling

****正劇；戲劇****

****tragedy****

= story involving severe suffering and usually disastrous consequences

****悲劇****

Not every drama is a tragedy.

27. drama vs comedy

****drama****

= usually serious and emotionally driven

****正劇****

****comedy****

= designed mainly to amuse

****喜劇****

A work can combine both.

28. drama vs fiction

This matters in the passage.

****fiction****

= broad category of invented storytelling

****虛構文學****

****drama****

= type or style emphasizing conflict, relationships, emotion, and serious situations

****戲劇 / 劇情類****

So ****fiction**** describes whether the story is invented, while ****drama**** describes how the story is structured or what kind of emotional content it has.

29. drama vs dramatic

****drama****

= noun

****戲劇；劇情；風波****

****dramatic****

= adjective

****戲劇性的；巨大的；誇張的****

Compare:

> a family ****drama****

> 家庭劇

> a ****dramatic**** change

> 巨大的變化

Meaning map

The central concept of **drama** is:

human action and conflict presented or experienced with emotional intensity

From this develop:

Literary / screen genre

drama

→ **正劇 / 劇情類作品**

Passage

philosophical drama

→ **探討人生與思想的嚴肅劇情**

Stage

a drama

→ **戲劇作品**

Art / study

study drama

→ **學戲劇**

Real event

plenty of drama

→ **充滿戲劇性的事情**

Social conflict

relationship drama

→ **人際風波**

Exaggeration

all that drama

→ **誇張反應 / 小題大做**

The family extends further:

dramatic increase

→ **大幅增加**

dramatic ending

→ **戲劇性結局**

dramatize a novel

→ **把小說改編成戲劇**

dramatize a problem

→ **把問題戲劇化 / 誇大**

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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drama — serious genre	以人物、情感、關係和衝突為核心的嚴肅劇情 / 正劇
drama — film/TV work	以劇情和人物衝突為主的電視劇 / 劇情片
drama — stage play	為演員舞台演出而寫的戲劇作品
drama — art/study	戲劇表演、創作與研究這門藝術
drama — exciting real events	現實中充滿緊張、意外或轉折的戲劇性事件
drama — interpersonal conflict	人與人之間的爭執、八卦、麻煩或情緒風波
drama — exaggerated reaction	過度誇張、小題大做的情緒反應
drama class/school	學習表演、戲劇創作等的課程 / 學校
dramatic — relating to drama	與戲劇或表演有關的
dramatic — major change	變化非常巨大或顯著的
dramatic — exciting	具有強烈緊張感或轉折的；戲劇性的
dramatic — exaggerated	行為、反應過度誇張的
dramatically — greatly	大幅地；顯著地
dramatically — theatrically	戲劇性地 / 誇張地
dramatize — adapt	把小說、事件等改編成戲劇形式
dramatize — exaggerate	把事情說得或表現得比實際更嚴重、更戲劇化
dramatization	將故事 / 真實事件改編或呈現為戲劇的版本
dramatist	創作戲劇作品的劇作家
historical drama	以歷史時期或事件為背景的歷史劇
crime drama	以犯罪、警察、調查等為中心的犯罪劇
family drama	以家庭關係與衝突為核心的家庭劇

period drama	設定於特定歷史年代的時代劇	
create drama	製造不必要的衝突、麻煩或風波	
get caught up in the drama	被捲入複雜的人際風波或衝突	
high drama	極度緊張、充滿轉折的戲劇性情況	

Passage recap

> "...a mix of fiction, fantasy, and philosophical ****drama****."

Here:

****drama**** = ****serious storytelling centered on human emotion, conflict, choices, and difficult situations****

Best Traditional Chinese:

* ****劇情****

* ****正劇****

* contextually: ****帶有哲思的劇情 / 戲劇元素****

Natural contextual translation:

****我會形容它是小說、奇幻，以及帶有哲思色彩的劇情元素的結合。****

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

****drama****

= ****a serious type of story that focuses on human relationships, emotions, conflicts, or important life situations****

****正劇；劇情類作品；戲劇性故事****

The most important contrast in this passage is:

> ****fiction****

> → tells us the story is invented

> ****fantasy****

> → tells us it contains unreal or imaginative elements

> ****drama****

> → tells us it focuses seriously on human emotion, conflict, and experience

So **philosophical drama** here does not mean a literal stage play. It describes the novel's **serious, idea-driven emotional storyline**.